**Requirements Gathering Document– StoryEcho**

**Description:**
A spoiler-free narrative companion app that helps viewers understand complex anime and TV series while reflecting on personal values through character empathy.

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**1. Introduction** **4**
**2. Requirements Gathering** **4**
2.1 Purpose and Objectives of the User Study 4
2.2 Choice of User Study and User Sample 4
2.2.1 Target User 4
2.2.2 Usage Context 4
2.2.3 User Study Method 4
2.3 Draft of User Study Survey and Interview 5
**2.3.1 Survey Design** **5**
**2.3.2 Interview Design** **5**
**2.4 Data Collection** **6**
**2.5 Data Visualization and Analysis** **6**
Figure 1: Age range of participants 6
Figure 2: Frequency of watching anime, TV series, or movie series 7
Figure 3: Participants' experience of confusion when watching long series 7
Figure 4: Common causes of confusion when following complex stories 8
Figure 5: Level of emotional connection to characters 8
Figure 6: Frequency of emotional reflection after watching episodes or seasons 9
Figure 7: Willingness to record or document feelings about stories or characters 9
Figure 8: Importance of avoiding spoilers 10
Figure 9: Platforms currently used to understand stories or track series 10
Figure 10: Perceived usefulness of spoiler-free story overviews 11
Figure 11: Perceived usefulness of emotional reflection or journaling features 11
Figure 12: Features that participants are most interested in 12
**2.6 Insights from Results** **12**
**3. Requirements Generation** **14**
3.1 Personas and Scenarios 14
3.2 Requirements Generated by Designers 16
**4. Synthesis of Requirement** **16**
Table 1. Requirements Specification Table 17
**5. AI Use Section** **18**
5.1 AI Tools Used 18
Table 2. AI Tools 18
5.2 Value Addition 18
5.3 Appendix – Prompt History 18
**6. Work Logs** **19**
Table 3. Team work logs 19
**7. Conclusion** **19**
**8. References** **19**
**9. Appendix** **20**
Appendix A: survey forms 20
Table 4. Survey from 20

Appendix B: interview scripts 22
Table 5. Interview Script 22
Appendix C: Other Supporting Materials 24
Appendix D: Persona Brainstorming Process 32

# 1. Introduction

Despite the availability of existing companion platforms, there is limited understanding of whether viewers feel a need for spoiler-free narrative clarification combined with emotional reflection tools. This project, therefore, aims to investigate users' actual needs, behaviors, and expectations through systematic requirements gathering.

# 2. Requirements Gathering

### 2.1 Purpose and Objectives of the User Study

The objective of this study is to understand how viewers currently manage complex narratives, how they emotionally engage with long-form stories, and whether there is a need for spoiler-free narrative clarification and reflection tools.
The specific objectives of the study are:

- To understand users' viewing habits and the challenges they face when following complex or long-form narratives.
- To identify how viewers emotionally engage with stories and whether they practice personal reflection after watching episodes.
- To explore users' attitudes toward spoilers and their experiences with existing platforms that provide story explanations or discussions.
- To assess users' interest in features such as reflection tools, journaling, and emotional mapping.

### 2.2 Choice of User Study and User Sample

#### 2.2.1 Target User

The target users include viewers of anime, movie series, and television series who actively engage with long-form narratives and develop emotional connections with characters and storylines. These users range from casual viewers who return to a series after long viewing gaps to dedicated fans who closely follow character development and narrative themes.

#### 2.2.2 Usage Context

*StoryEcho* is used in a variety of viewing and social contexts, such as:

- Watching long-form series that involve complex plots, timelines, or large casts of characters.
- Viewing content across multiple seasons or returning to a series after long breaks.
- Experiencing emotional engagement during or after watching episodes.
- Personal reflection moments, such as journaling thoughts or feelings after finishing an episode.
- Social contexts, such as recommending shows or discussing themes with friends.

### 2.2.3 User Study Method

This study adopts a mixed-methods approach that combines online surveys and semi-structured interviews.
Surveys are used to collect broad quantitative insights into users' viewing behaviors, habits, and feature preferences. Interviews allow for deeper qualitative exploration of users' emotional engagement with stories and their reflection practices.

Online surveys were selected because they are efficient and accessible for collecting responses from a larger sample. Semi-structured interviews were included to gain richer insights into users' personal experiences and motivations.

## 2.3 Draft of User Study Survey and Interview

### 2.3.1 Survey Design

This survey aims to understand how viewers of anime, movie series, and TV series follow complex stories and emotionally engage with them. Your responses will help us design a spoiler-free app that supports narrative understanding and personal reflection.
The survey contents include, see the appendix section:

- Section 1: Demographics
- Section 2: Viewing Habits & Behaviors
- Section 3: Emotional Engagement & Reflection
- Section 4: Spoilers & Current Solutions
- Section 5: Feature Interest & Preferences
- Section 6: Open-ended Questions

The survey questions follow a logical progression from general viewing habits to more specific questions about emotional engagement and feature preferences. Design considerations include avoiding leading questions, avoiding double negatives, and combining both closed-ended and open-ended questions.
The complete survey questionnaire is provided in the Appendix.

### 2.3.2 Interview Design

The semi-structured interview is designed to explore users' experiences with complex narratives and their emotional connections to stories and characters.
The interview follows a structured flow that includes the following stages:

- Warm-up
- Narrative Understanding
- Emotional Engagement
- Reflection & Tools
- Closing

Open-ended questions are used to encourage participants to share detailed experiences rather than short or confirmatory responses. The design of the interview avoids leading questions in order to ensure that participants can express their authentic opinions and experiences.

Examples of interview questions include:

- "Can you describe a time when you felt emotionally connected to a character or story?"
- "What do you usually do when you forget story details or feel confused?"
- "What kind of tool would help you reflect on stories in a more meaningful way?"

These sample questions illustrate the types of topics explored during the interview. The complete interview script is included in the Appendix.

## 2.4 Data Collection

The survey was distributed through Google Forms and collected responses from 17 participants. Participants were recruited through online student communities and social media channels related to anime, television series, and movie discussions.

In addition to the survey, 8 semi-structured interviews were conducted online to gain deeper insights into viewers' emotional engagement and reflection practices when following complex narratives.

The survey collected quantitative data about viewing habits, emotional engagement, and feature preferences, while the interviews provided qualitative insights into users' personal experiences and challenges when following long-form stories.

## 2.5 Data Visualization and Analysis

The survey collected responses from 17 participants. The quantitative data were visualized using pie charts and bar charts to illustrate participants' viewing habits, emotional engagement, and attitudes toward spoiler-free storytelling tools.

Each visualization corresponds to a specific survey question and helps identify patterns in user behavior and preferences.

The survey results are summarized in the following figures:

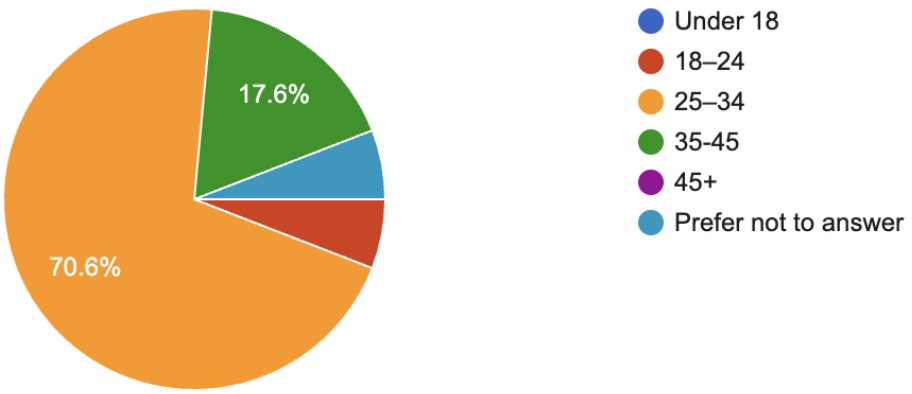


Figure 1: Age range of participants

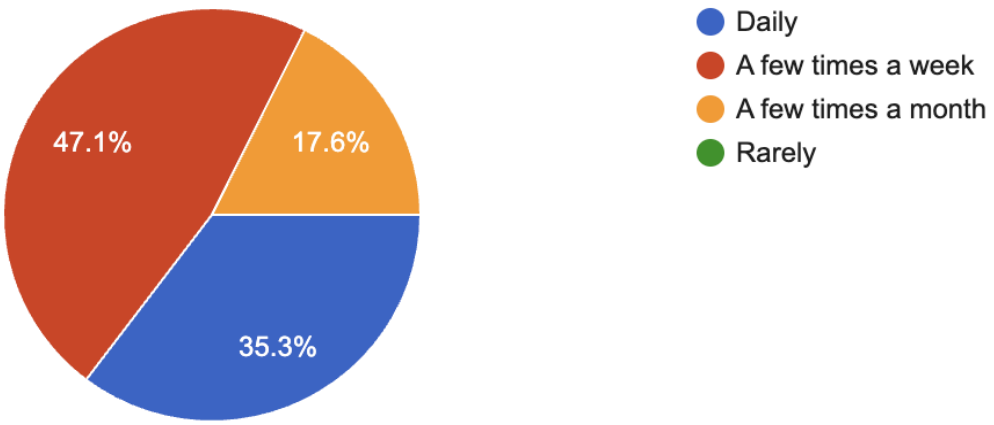


Figure 2: Frequency of watching anime, TV series, or movie series

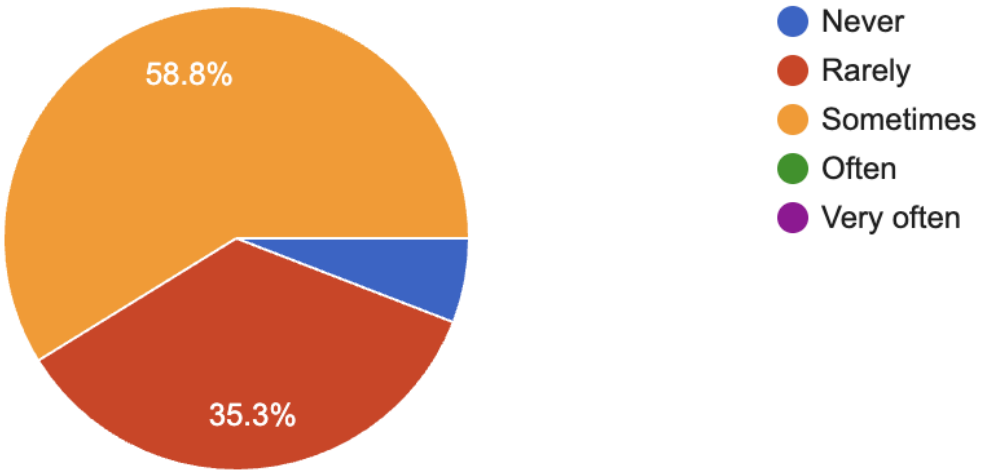

Figure 3: Participants' experience of confusion when watching long series

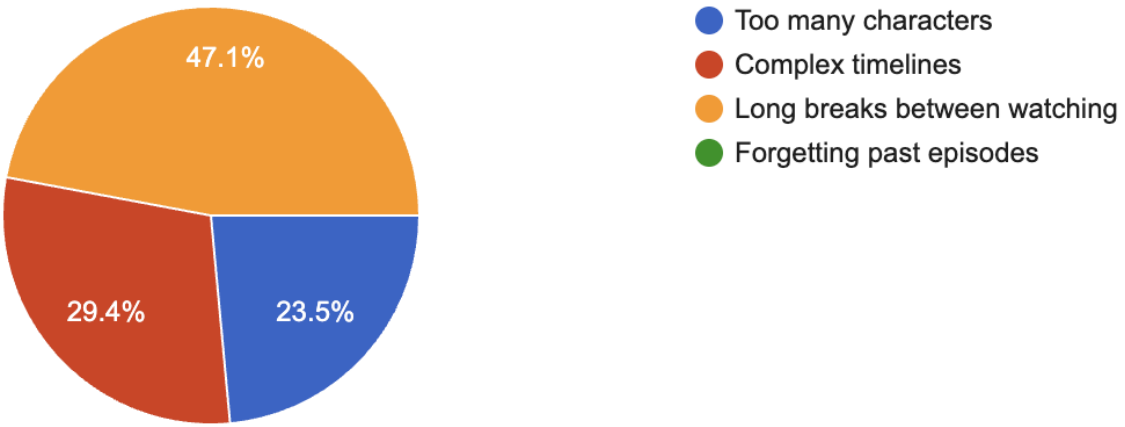


Figure 4: Common causes of confusion when following complex stories

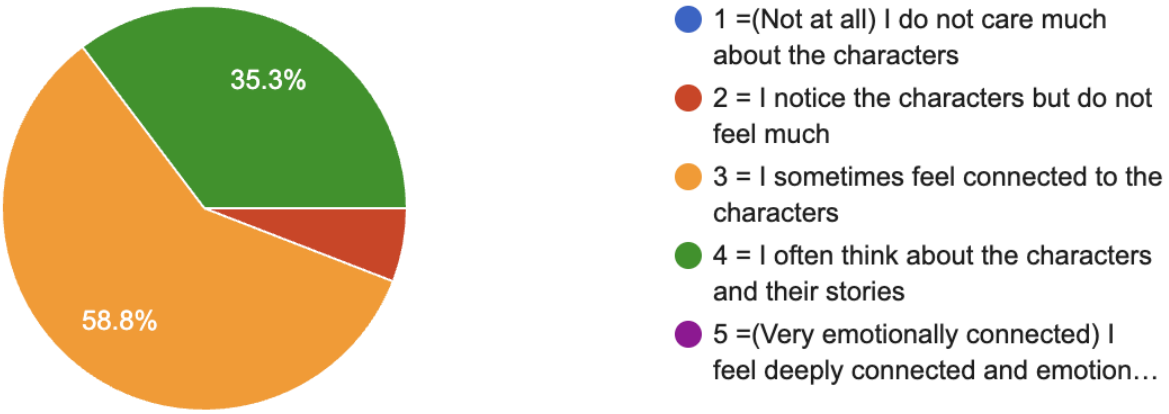


Figure 5: Level of emotional connection to characters

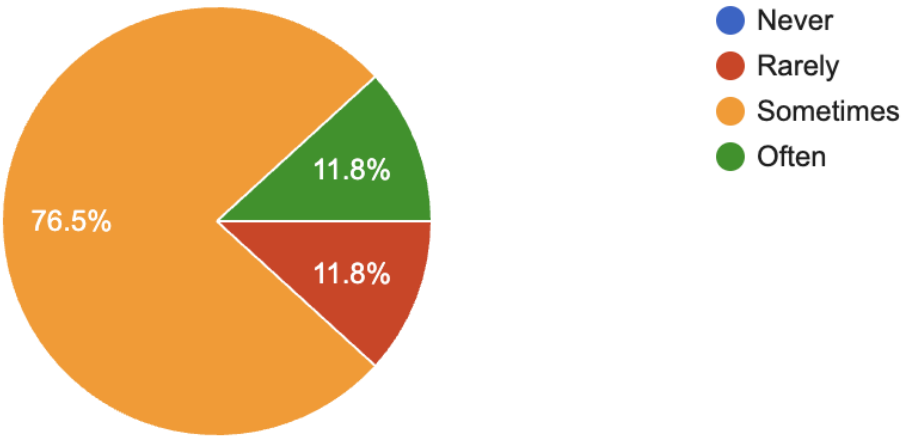


Figure 6: Frequency of emotional reflection after watching episodes or seasons

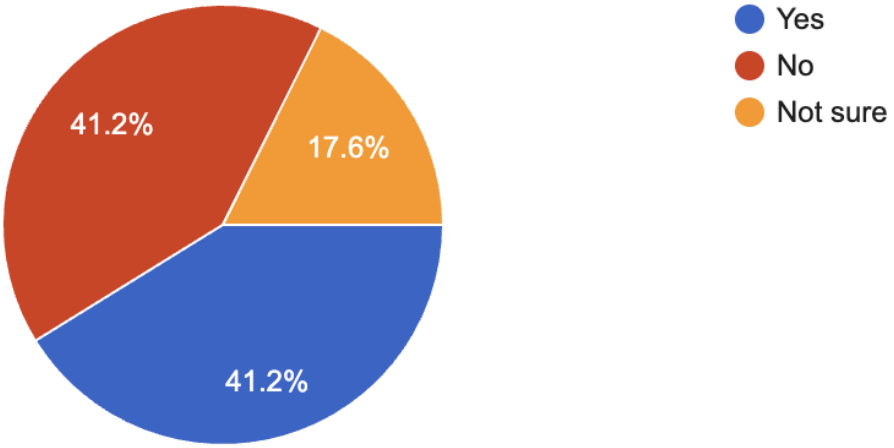


Figure 7: Willingness to record or document feelings about stories or characters

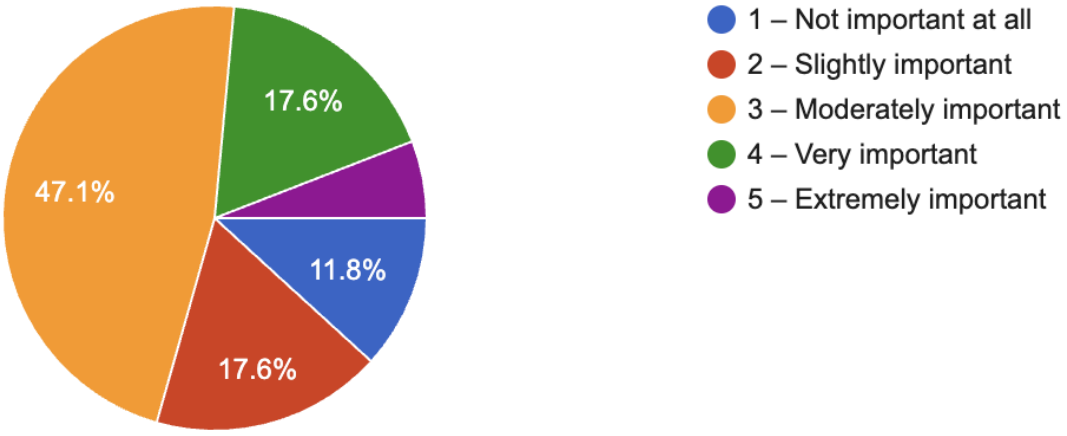


Figure 8: Importance of avoiding spoilers

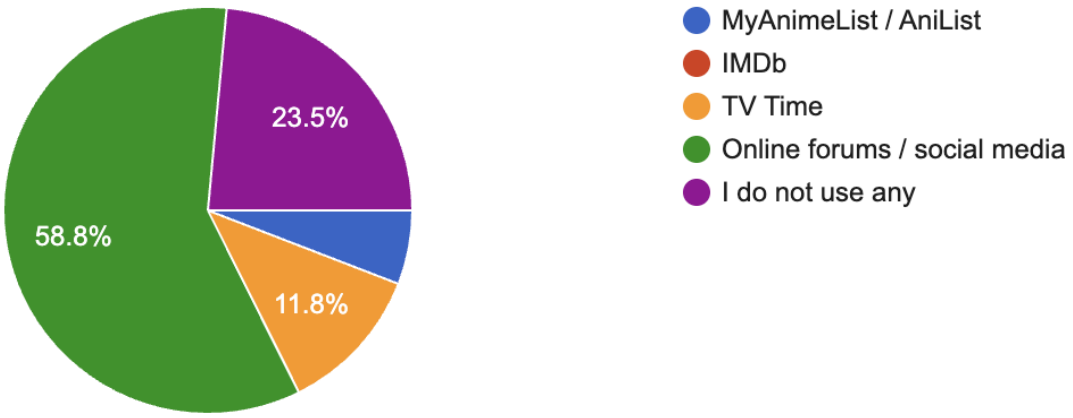


Figure 9: Platforms currently used to understand stories or track series

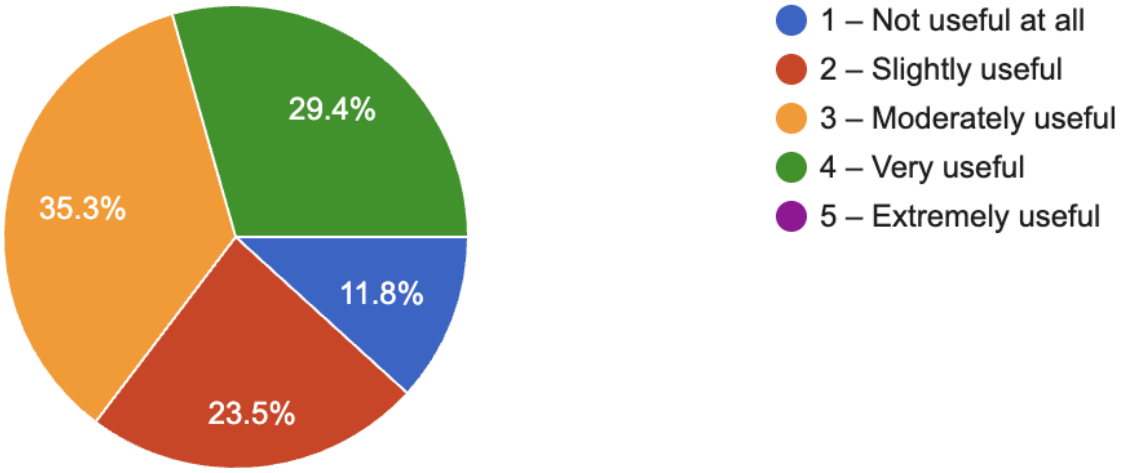


Figure 10: Perceived usefulness of spoiler-free story overviews

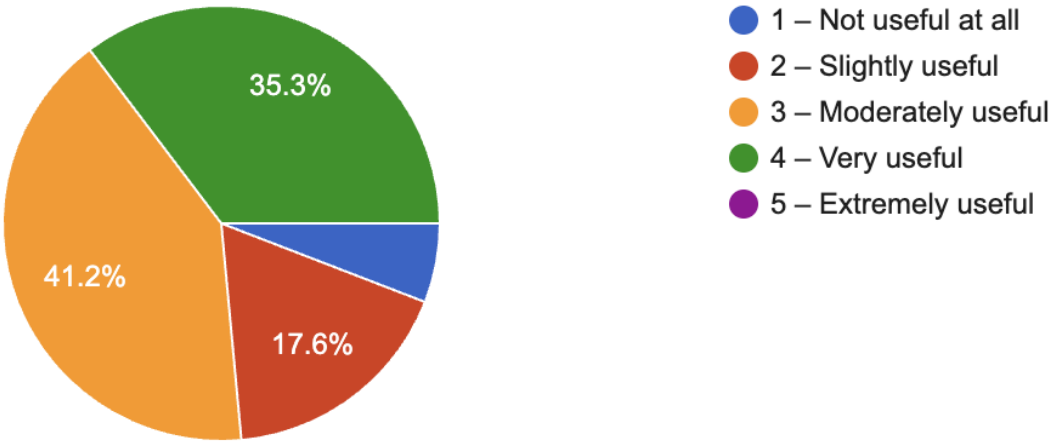


Figure 11: Perceived usefulness of emotional reflection or journaling features

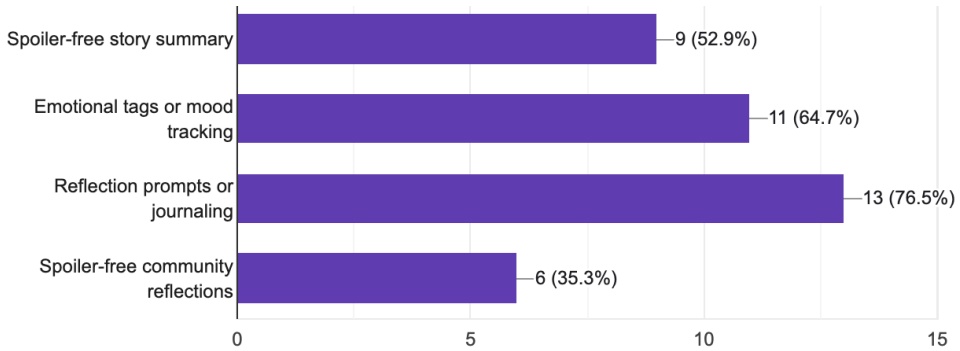


Figure 12: Features that participants are most interested in

These visualizations provide an overview of users' narrative experiences and help identify opportunities for designing tools that support spoiler-free story clarification and emotional reflection.

## 2.6 Insights from Results

Key insights derived from the study include:

- **Cognitive Load and Narrative Fragmentation:**
  Viewers frequently experience "narrative drift," where the intricate details of complex subplots or secondary character motivations fade during long gaps between episodes or seasons, leading to a fragmented understanding of the story.
- **The Conflict Between Clarification and Spoiler Risks:**
  There is a significant tension for the active viewer who seeks to resolve confusion through external sources—such as wikis or video essays—but faces a high risk of encountering unsolicited spoilers that diminish the impact of future plot twists.
- **Unmet Demand for Deeper Psychological Engagement:**
  While many viewers engage in profound emotional and ethical reflection regarding a character's growth and moral dilemmas, current entertainment platforms offer no structured way to document or process these personal insights.
- **Social Media Fatigue and the Need for Private Spaces:**
  Most existing digital tools prioritize public discourse and "fan hype," which can feel performative or overwhelming for users who prefer a more introspective, private environment to analyze a story's craftsmanship.

Based on these findings, several design implications for *StoryEcho* were identified:

- **Progress-Aware, Spoiler-Gated Summaries:**
  *StoryEcho* must implement a dynamic summary system that scales information based on the user's specific progress, ensuring that recaps provide necessary clarity without ever revealing details beyond the current episode.
- **Integrated Personal Reflection and Journaling Modules:**
  The platform should feature dedicated tools for private notation, allowing users to record their reactions to character arcs and life lessons, effectively turning the viewing experience into a tool for self-reflection.

- **Character Evolution and Relationship Mapping:**
  To support analytical viewers, the tool should provide visual trackers that map character growth, emotional shifts, and changing relationships, helping users visualize the "logic" behind the narrative's development.
- **Efficiency-Focused Information Architecture:**
  Recognizing that time is a premium for many users, the interface must prioritize concise, high-impact data—such as "Quick Catch-ups"—over the cluttered and often redundant information found on generic fan forums.

# 3. Requirements Generation

## 3.1 Personas and Scenarios

The personas presented in this section were developed through a team brainstorming session. During the meeting, team members discussed insights gathered from the survey and interview results and generated several potential user profiles that represent different viewing behaviors and needs.

The team collaboratively refined these ideas and organized them into structured personas and scenarios that represent typical users of the proposed *StoryEcho* application. The summarized personas are presented below, while the original brainstorming notes and detailed drafts are included in the Appendix.

To better understand different types of viewers and their needs, six personas were created based on insights from the survey and interview results. Each persona represents a different viewing style, emotional engagement level, and challenge when following long-form narratives. These personas help guide the generation of design requirements for the *StoryEcho* application.

**Persona 1: Tony**

**Age:** 35
**Background:** Taiwanese, currently on a working holiday in Canada. Tony grew up watching anime and TV dramas, especially mystery and science fiction series.
**Lifestyle:** Tony works long shifts from 5 am to 4 pm. After work, he relaxes by cooking dinner while watching anime or TV series on his tablet.
**Goals**

- Enjoy complex and engaging storylines
- Discuss interesting episodes and characters with friends
- Understand the deeper meanings behind stories

**Frustrations**

- Frequently forgets character relationships in long series
- Gets confused when multiple storylines overlap
- Needs to rewatch episodes to remember key details

**Scenario**
After returning home from work, Tony prepares dinner while watching an episode of an anime series. Because he watches while cooking, he occasionally misses details in the story. When several characters appear in complicated plotlines, he becomes confused about their relationships and motivations.
**Needs**

- Spoiler-free summaries to quickly recall important story events
- Visual tracking of character relationships
- Tools that help clarify complex plot developments

**Persona 2: Ikumi**

**Age:** 28
**Background:** Japanese, currently on a working holiday in Canada. She works at a Japanese restaurant and a café.
**Lifestyle:** Ikumi enjoys watching Japanese dramas and slice-of-life anime. She prefers calm and emotionally meaningful stories.
**Goals**

- Enjoy relaxing and emotionally rich storytelling
- Reflect on character emotions and personal values

**Frustrations**

- Sometimes struggles to organize her thoughts after emotionally impactful episodes
- Has no structured way to capture reflections about characters or story themes

**Scenario**

After work, Ikumi sits in her apartment with a cup of coffee and watches a Japanese drama. She enjoys following subtle emotional changes between characters and quietly reflecting on the story.

**Needs**

- Light reflection prompts to help organize emotional responses
- A simple journaling tool to record thoughts about stories and characters

### Persona 3: Eduardo

**Age:** 26
**Background:** Peruvian international student studying in Canada.
**Lifestyle:** Eduardo balances university studies with free time. Watching anime and series is one of his main ways to relax.

**Goals**

- Watch meaningful stories with strong character development
- Feel inspired by characters overcoming challenges

**Frustrations**

- Sometimes forgets important details when returning to a series
- Searches online explanations but often encounters spoilers

**Scenario**

After finishing his classes, Eduardo watches an episode of an anime series. When he feels confused about the storyline, he searches for explanations on YouTube or online forums to understand the story better.

**Needs**

- Spoiler-free explanations of plot details
- Concise summaries that clarify story developments without revealing future events

### Persona 4: Oke

**Age:** 29
**Background:** Nigerian student studying computer science in Canada.
**Lifestyle:** Oke enjoys coding and solving complex problems. In his free time, he watches thriller series and mystery-driven anime.

**Goals**

- Analyze complex narratives and hidden clues
- Fully understand the logic behind story developments

**Frustrations**

- Dislikes plot holes or confusing storylines
- Needs detailed explanations to understand character motivations

**Scenario**

After a long day of studying and coding, Oke watches a thriller series. He enjoys analyzing character motives and predicting plot twists. When he suspects he missed a clue, he searches online for explanation videos to better understand the storyline.

**Needs**

- Analytical summaries explaining character motivations
- Tools to track relationships and story logic

### Persona 5: Anna

**Age:** 27
**Background:** First-generation Canadian student studying at UBC.
**Lifestyle:** Anna balances university classes, studying, and social time with friends. She usually watches

anime or TV series in the evening to relax.
**Goals**
- Enjoy character-driven stories and emotional development
- Relax after a busy day of studying

**Frustrations**
- Sometimes loses track of characters in long series
- Searches online summaries but accidentally encounters spoilers

**Scenario**
After finishing her schoolwork, Anna watches an episode of her favorite anime on her laptop. When she forgets character relationships, she searches online for explanations but occasionally runs into spoilers that ruin future plot twists.
**Needs**
- A safe way to review character relationships
- Spoiler-controlled summaries for past episodes

### Persona 6: Delvin

**Age:** 30
**Background:** Works full-time in Canada and enjoys watching action series, thrillers, and anime.
**Lifestyle:** Delvin watches shows in his free time after work as a way to relax and escape daily stress.
**Goals**
- Enjoy exciting plots and unexpected twists
- Quickly understand story developments without spending too much time searching for explanations

**Frustrations**
- Has to search multiple websites to understand complex plots
- Finds it inconvenient to track character relationships across long series

**Scenario**
After work, Delvin watches several episodes of a thriller series. When a complicated plot twist appears, he pauses the show and searches online for explanations, which interrupts his viewing experience.
**Needs**
- Quick recap tools to understand story progression
- A centralized place to review character relationships and key events

### 3.2 Requirements Generated by Designers

Based on the analysis of personas and scenarios, the following user needs were identified:

- Users need spoiler-free summaries to recall important story events without revealing future plot developments.
- Users need tools to track character relationships and understand interactions between multiple characters.
- Users need a way to record personal reflections and emotional responses after watching episodes.
- Users need quick access to episode recaps when returning to a series after long gaps.
- Users need visual aids to understand character development and narrative progression.
- Users need private reflection spaces rather than public discussion platforms.

## 4. Synthesis of Requirement

Based on the user study results and persona analysis, the requirements for *StoryEcho* are divided into functional and non-functional categories. Functional requirements describe what users expect the system to do, such as selecting characters, recording reflections, and

viewing community insights. Non-functional requirements describe how the system should perform, including usability, privacy, response time, and clarity of information.

Prioritized Requirements:

**Must-Have**

- Spoiler filtering
- Episode recap system
- Reflection journal

**Should-Have**

- Emotional tagging
- Character tracking

**Nice-to-Have**

- Community insights

Table 1. Requirements Specification Table

| Requirement Type | Description | *StoryEcho* | Must/Should/Could/Want |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Functional** | What the system must allow users to do | Select a character to reflect on emotions | **Must** |
| **Functional** | What the system must allow users to do | Record personal reflection (emotion/value) | **Must** |
| **Functional** | What the system must allow users to do | View aggregated community emotional insights | **Should** |
| **Functional** | What the system must allow users to do | Search or select Movie / Anime / TV Series | **Must** |
| **Functional** | What the system must allow users to do | Browse past reflections (history) | **Could** |
| **Non-functional** | How the system should perform | The user interface is simple and easy to navigate | **Must** |
| **Non-functional** | How the system should perform | Reflection data loading time ≤ 2 seconds | **Should** |

| Requirement Type | Description | *StoryEcho* | Must/Should/Could/Want |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Non-functional** | How the system should perform | User data is anonymous and secure | **Must** |
| **Non-functional** | How the system should perform | Visual layout is consistent across media types | **Should** |
| **Non-functional** | How the system should perform | Emotional & value options are clearly labeled | **Must** |

# 5. AI Use Section

## 5.1 AI Tools Used

Table 2. AI Tools

| AI Tool | Version | Account | Use |
|---|---|---|---|
| ChatGPT | GPT-5.2 | Free | Drafting personas & structure |
| Gemini | Gemini 3 | Free | Elaborating on concise points |

## 5.2 Value Addition

- The responses collected from participants were carefully reviewed and interpreted by the project team to identify patterns in viewing behaviors and user needs. The team analyzed how participants described their experiences with complex stories, confusion about characters or timelines, and their strategies for recalling story details. These interpretations required human judgment to understand participants' perspectives and translate them into meaningful insights beyond what AI tools could generate automatically.
- Based on these insights, the team determined the design direction of the proposed application, *StoryEcho*.
- The personas, scenarios, and system concepts were developed through collaborative brainstorming sessions among team members. During these discussions, the team translated user insights into representative user profiles and usage scenarios. These human-driven interpretations guided the development of key features such as spoiler-free summaries, character relationship tracking, and reflection tools.

## 5.3 Appendix – Prompt History

- Prompt Type 1: Generalizing user descriptions
  "Help generalize user descriptions and insights, so they represent broader viewer behaviors rather than specific individuals."
- Prompt Type 2: Improving academic writing

"Help revise the following paragraph to make it clearer and more suitable for an academic report."

- Prompt Type 3: Structuring research sections
  "Provide a clear structure for presenting personas and scenarios in a user-experience design report."
- Prompt Type 4: Refining design implications
  "Help organize research insights into potential design implications for a media reflection tool."

## 6. Work Logs

Table 3. Team work logs

| Team member | Date | Number of Hours | Description of Work Done | Contribution |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Derrick | Mar 2, 2026 | 3 | Target User Definition | 33.33% |
| | Mar 3, 2026 | 2 | Draft of User Study Survey and Interview | |
| | Mar 4, 2026 | 2.5 | Synthesis of Requirement | |
| | Mar 5, 2026 | 3 | Requirements Generation | |
| Jude | Mar 1, 2026 | 3 | Methodology Description | 33.33% |
| | Mar 2, 2026 | 3 | Data Collection | |
| | Mar 3, 2026 | 2.5 | Data Analysis | |
| | Mar 4, 2026 | 3 | Requirements Generation | |
| Sin-Yi | Mar 2, 2026 | 3 | Survey Collection | 33.33% |
| | Mar 3, 2026 | 3 | Interview Collection | |
| | Mar 7, 2026 | 2.5 | Requirements Generation | |
| | Mar 8, 2026 | 3 | Report Review | |

## 7. Conclusion

This requirements gathering study aimed to inform the design of *StoryEcho* by grounding design decisions in real user needs and behaviors. Through surveys and interviews, we explored how viewers follow complex stories and emotionally engage with characters and narratives.

The results highlight common challenges, including:

- Remembering character relationships

- Understanding long or complex storylines
- Avoiding spoilers when seeking explanations or recaps

These insights guided the design of *StoryEcho* as a spoiler-free companion tool that supports narrative understanding, personal reflection, and meaningful engagement with media content.

## 8. References


*ChatGPT (OpenAI). (2026). GPT-5.2 model. OpenAI. https://openai.com*
*Google DeepMind. (2026). Gemini 3 AI tool. https://deepmind.com*
*MyAnimeList. (2026). Anime & Manga database. https://myanimelist.net*
*IMDb. (2026). Internet Movie Database. https://www.imdb.com*
*TV Time. (2026). TV show tracking platform. https://www.tvtime.com*


## 9. Appendix

### Appendix A: survey forms

This appendix includes the survey forms.

Table 4. Survey from

| Section | Topic |
|---|---|
| Section 1: | Demographics |
| 1. What is your age range?<br>☐ Under 18<br>☐ 18–24<br>☐ 25–34<br>☐ 35–44<br>☐ 45+<br>☐ Prefer not to answer | |
| 2. How often do you watch anime, TV series, or movie series?<br>☐ Daily<br>☐ A few times a week<br>☐ A few times a month<br>☐ Rarely | |
| Section 2: | Viewing Habits & Behaviors |
| 3. Have you ever felt confused about the story when watching a long series?<br>☐ Never<br>☐ Rarely<br>☐ Sometimes<br>☐ Often<br>☐ Very often | |
| 4. What usually causes confusion for you?<br>☐ Too many characters<br>☐ Complex timelines | |

| Section | Topic |
|---|---|
| ☐ Long breaks between watching<br>☐ Forgetting past episodes<br>☐ Other: _____ | |
| Section 3: | Emotional Engagement & Reflection |
| 5. How emotionally connected do you feel to characters in series you enjoy?<br>(1 = Not at all, 5 = Very emotionally connected)<br>☐ 1 = I do not care much about the characters<br>☐ 2 = I notice the characters but do not feel much<br>☐ 3 = I sometimes feel connected to the characters<br>☐ 4 = I often think about the characters and their stories<br>☐ 5 = I feel deeply connected and emotionally affected | |
| 6. After watching an episode or season, do you reflect on how it made you feel?<br>☐ Never<br>☐ Rarely<br>☐ Sometimes<br>☐ Often | |
| 7. Have you ever wanted to write down or record your feelings about a story or character?<br>☐ Yes<br>☐ No<br>☐ Not sure | |
| Section 4: | Spoilers & Current Solutions |
| 8. How important is avoiding spoilers for you?<br>☐ 1 – Not important at all<br>☐ 2 – Slightly important<br>☐ 3 – Moderately important<br>☐ 4 – Very important<br>☐ 5 – Extremely important | |
| 9. Which platforms do you currently use to understand stories or track series?<br>☐ MyAnimeList / AniList<br>☐ IMDb<br>☐ TV Time<br>☐ Online forums / social media<br>☐ I do not use any<br>☐ Other: _____ | |
| 10. What problems do you face with these platforms? | |
| Section 5: | Feature Interest & Preferences |
| 11. How useful would a spoiler-free story overview be for you?<br>☐ 1 – Not useful at all | |

| Section | Topic |
|---|---|
| ☐ 2 – Slightly useful<br>☐ 3 – Moderately useful<br>☐ 4 – Very useful<br>☐ 5 – Extremely useful | |
| 12. How useful would emotional reflection or journaling features be?<br>☐ 1 – Not useful at all<br>☐ 2 – Slightly useful<br>☐ 3 – Moderately useful<br>☐ 4 – Very useful<br>☐ 5 – Extremely useful | |
| 13. Which features would you be most interested in? (Select up to 3)<br>☐ Character relationship map<br>☐ Spoiler-free story summary<br>☐ Emotional tags or mood tracking<br>☐ Reflection prompts or journaling<br>☐ Spoiler-free community reflections | |
| Section 6: | Open-ended Questions |
| 14. What do you find most meaningful about the stories you love? | |
| 15. If an app could support your viewing experience, what would you want it to help you with? | |

## Appendix B: interview scripts

This appendix includes the interview scripts.

Table 5. Interview Script

| Section | Interview Script |
|---|---|
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your |

| Section | Interview Script |
| --- | --- |
| | values? |
| | |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | |

**Appendix C: Other Supporting Materials**

From the total interview participants, eight representative users were selected for detailed analysis. These participants were chosen because they reflect diverse viewing habits, narrative engagement styles, and different strategies for dealing with story complexity. The selected users provide a balanced representation of emotional viewers, analytical viewers, and casual viewers across different cultural backgrounds.

| Interview participation 1 | Stacy 🇹🇼 |
|---|---|
| Section | Interview Script |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | I mostly watch Japanese anime, especially slice-of-life and fantasy stories. I like shows that focus on character growth rather than action. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Yes, especially when there are too many characters or timelines. Sometimes I forget who belongs to which faction and the characters' names. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | I usually search character charts or discuss with someone who has watched that before |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | Characters who struggle quietly stay with me because they feel realistic. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | Yes, I realize I value perseverance and kindness a lot. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | Sometimes I share my feelings with my friends after finishing an anime. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | A timeline or emotional journal connected to episodes. |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | Platforms don't help viewers reflect — only recommend. |

| Interview participation 2 | Tony 🇹🇼 |
|---|---|
| Section | Interview Script |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | I watch anime and TV dramas equally, especially mystery and sci-fi. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Yes, sometimes I watch the same episode again and again because I sometimes feel confused about the content. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | Breaking Bad characters stayed with me because of moral conflict. |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | I rewatch previous episodes at a higher speed. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | Stories make me question right and wrong, and sometimes I will think about reality between the lines of the content. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | I discuss shows with friends more than writing. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | If the app could do summaries per episode would help. |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | Hard to track character relationships. |

| Interview participation 3 | Ben 🇨🇱 |
|---|---|
| Section | Interview Script |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | I enjoy anime, but also Western series like dark dramas. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Yes, especially political shows. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | I check Reddit discussions. |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | Attack on Titan affected me emotionally because of the sacrifice themes. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | Stories show me how humans react under pressure. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | I sometimes journal privately in my phone notes. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | A place combining notes + community discussion. |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | Streaming apps feel isolating. |

| Interview participation 4 | Edwin 🇹🇼 |
| --- | --- |
| Section | Interview Script |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | Recently, I watched some historical series or alternate history shows, such as Vikings and Peaky Blinders. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Usually, it is because I want to understand the characters' backgrounds or the overall historical development better. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | I usually search for related information online. Wikipedia is the fastest way. |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | Thomas Shelby, played by Cillian Murphy. Besides his excellent acting, the character stays calm when facing difficulties and always finds a way to fight back, which is very impressive. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | I often try to understand the meaning behind each show and reflect on it with my own values. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | Usually I write some notes for myself, and sometimes I mention them when chatting with others. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | It would be helpful to see multiple articles with different perspectives, so I can compare my own thoughts with other people's ideas |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | It would be nice if platforms could show recent news or events related to the series. |

| Interview participation 5 | Becky 🇬🇧 |
|---|---|
| Section | Interview Script |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | I usually enjoy movies or series that are thought-provoking, but sometimes I like lighthearted comedy to unwind. Occasionally, I'll watch sci-fi or detective shows when I want a change of pace. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Yes, sometimes in shows with lots of plot twists or many characters, I can lose track of who's who. I usually pause and think back, or even make mental notes to keep up. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | I'll check a quick recap online or read summaries. Sometimes I just rewatch the key scene to remind myself. |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | I tend to remember characters who struggle emotionally but grow through their challenges. Their journey often resonates with my own thoughts on human behavior and psychology. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | Yes, I notice I'm drawn to stories about resilience and empathy. It reflects my interest in human psychology and understanding people. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | I sometimes jot down thoughts in a journal, especially if a story made me reflect deeply. I also enjoy chatting with friends about interesting character choices. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | A tool that helps me track character decisions and emotional arcs would be great. Something visual that shows how characters evolve through the story would help me reflect more. |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | Most platforms just let me watch, but don't help me engage with the story deeply. I wish there were features for reflecting on character growth or connecting story themes to personal insights. |

| Interview participation 6 | Guillermo 🇲🇽 |
|---|---|
| Section | Interview Script |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | I mostly enjoy action and fantasy series. I like stories with big worlds, like magic systems, different kingdoms, or futuristic settings. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Yes, especially when the story has heavy world-building. Sometimes there are too many rules, locations, or political groups introduced at once, and I honestly couldn't remember who was allied with whom anymore. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | I usually go to YouTube and search for explanation videos or episode breakdowns. Some creators explain things really clearly with visuals, which helps a lot. |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | Hero journey stories always stay with me. I like characters who start weak or unsure but slowly grow stronger through challenges. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | Yeah, I think these stories show that I value courage and persistence. I admire characters who keep going even when they're scared. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | I don't usually write things down, but I like discussing shows in online forums or comment sections. Sometimes reading other people's interpretations makes me notice themes I completely missed. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | An interactive world map would be amazing — something that shows locations, factions, and character movements as the story progresses. |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | I feel current streaming platforms focus only on watching, not experiencing. There aren't many tools that help you feel inside the story world. |

| Interview participation 7 | Kristy 🇭🇰 |
|---|---|
| Section | Interview Script |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | I mostly watch K-dramas, especially romantic ones, after work to relax. I like stories that focus on relationships and emotional moments. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Yes, I often get confused when there are too many side characters. Sometimes I forget how they are connected to the main couple. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | I usually read drama blogs or episode recaps online. They help me quickly remember what happened before. |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | I really like slow-burn romance stories where feelings develop naturally. Watching characters slowly fall in love feels very real to me. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | Yes, sometimes I think K-dramas shape how I imagine relationships. They make me reflect on what kind of love I actually want. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | I usually talk with friends instead of writing things down. We like sharing reactions right after new episodes come out. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | A character reminder tool would be really helpful while watching. Something that quickly shows who each person is without spoilers. |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | It's hard to find my favorite scenes again once I finish a drama. I wish platforms allowed easier bookmarking of emotional moments. |

| Interview participation 8 | Yubin 🇰🇷 |
|---|---|
| **Section** | **Interview Script** |
| Warm-up | Can you tell me what kind of shows or series you usually enjoy? |
| | I mostly watch emotional K-dramas, especially ones with complex relationships and heartfelt moments. I like stories that make me feel connected to the characters, sometimes even crying a little. |
| Narrative Understanding | Have you ever felt lost when following a long or complex story? Can you describe that experience? |
| | Yes, especially when there are multiple families or generations involved. Sometimes I have to pause and think, "Wait, who is related to whom?" It can be confusing but also kind of fun trying to keep track. |
| | What do you usually do when you forget story details or characters? |
| | I usually read Korean forums or discussion threads online. Fans are great at summarizing relationships and key events, and sometimes I find new insights I hadn't noticed while watching. |
| Emotional Engagement | Are there any characters or stories that stayed with you emotionally? Why? |
| | I really like healing characters who bring comfort and calmness, like a friend I wish I had. They make the story feel warm and sometimes even help me deal with my own feelings. |
| | Do you ever think about what these stories say about you or your values? |
| | Yes, I feel like these stories help me process my own emotions. Watching characters face challenges or heartbreak makes me reflect on my own relationships and how I handle feelings. |
| Reflection & Tools | Have you ever written or talked about your feelings after watching a show? |
| | I usually keep a private diary where I jot down my thoughts and emotions after an episode. Sometimes I write a lot, sometimes just a few lines, but it helps me feel grounded. |
| | What kind of tool would make reflection easier or more meaningful for you? |
| | I think prompts or questions that help me reflect on my feelings during or after an episode would be helpful |
| Closing | Is there anything missing from current platforms that you wish existed? |
| | Most streaming platforms don't remember or track how I felt during a show. I wish they could somehow record emotional responses or favorite moments so I could revisit them later. |

## Appendix D: Persona Brainstorming Process

The following notes document the brainstorming process used to develop the personas for the *StoryEcho* application. During a team meeting, members discussed different types of viewers based on survey insights and personal viewing experiences. Each member proposed potential user profiles, which were later refined and structured into the personas presented in Section 3.1.

### Tony Persona Scenario

**Name:** Tony 🇹🇼
**Age:** 35
**Background:** Taiwanese, currently on a working holiday in Canada. Grew up loving anime and TV dramas, especially mystery and sci-fi.
**Lifestyle:** Works 5 am–4 pm, enjoys cooking while watching shows, often re-watches episodes, and loves discussing shows with friends.

**Tony's Viewing Journey**

1. **Meet Tony**
   Tony returns to his small apartment after a long day at work. He starts preparing dinner while streaming an anime or TV drama on his tablet. Cooking and watching at the same time is his way to unwind, and he often pauses to rewatch favorite scenes or laugh at funny moments with friends over chat.
2. **Challenge with Complex Stories**
   Tony sometimes feels lost in complex stories, especially when multiple characters or intertwining plots are involved. He often ends up watching the same episode repeatedly because he forgets certain details or who each character is.
3. **Maintaining Understanding**
   When he forgets story details, Tony replays key episodes at higher speed or discusses confusing parts with friends. He likes to connect storylines to moral conflicts and human behavior, especially in shows like *Breaking Bad*, where ethical dilemmas stay with him.
4. **Emotional Engagement**
   Certain characters and story arcs resonate strongly with Tony because of their moral complexity or emotional depth. He reflects on right and wrong, and sometimes he thinks about the reality behind the story or the life lessons implied between the lines.
5. **Social Discussion**
   Tony enjoys discussing shows with friends more than writing his thoughts down. Conversations help him process what he watched, debate character choices, and share favorite moments, deepening his engagement with the story.
6. **Needs for Better Tracking**
   Tony wishes he could more easily track character relationships and story progression. Without a clear way to keep tabs on connections and key events, he sometimes struggles to fully appreciate long or complicated series.
7. **Daily Routine**
   He balances a busy work schedule with his love for shows, often cooking and watching in tandem, occasionally rewatching episodes, and reflecting on why certain moments or characters resonate with him. This combination of routine, reflection, and social interaction defines how he engages with content.

## Ikumi Persona Scenario

**Name:** Ikumi 🇯🇵
**Age:** 28
**Background:** Japanese, currently on a working holiday in Canada. Works at a Japanese restaurant and a café.
**Lifestyle:** Enjoys watching Japanese dramas and slice-of-life anime. Prefers calm, slow-paced stories that she can savor.

**Ikumi's Viewing Journey**

1. **Daily Routine**
   After work, Ikumi often sits in her small apartment with a cup of coffee, watching a Japanese drama or a gentle slice-of-life anime. She enjoys quiet, relaxing stories and likes to soak in the subtle emotions of the characters while sipping her drink.
2. **Watching Pace and Understanding**
   She rarely feels lost in long or complex stories because she watches slowly and carefully. Taking her time allows her to follow character relationships and story developments without confusion.
3. **Handling Forgotten Details**
   When she forgets story or character details, Ikumi keeps mental notes or quietly recalls the events herself, rather than relying on external tools. This helps her maintain a coherent understanding of the story.
4. **Emotional Engagement**
   She is particularly moved by gentle, considerate characters. These characters often make her reflect on her own behavior and values, reminding her to be thoughtful and kind in her daily life.
5. **Personal Reflection**
   Ikumi prefers to reflect quietly on her feelings rather than share them with others. She enjoys processing her emotional responses internally and understanding what the story has made her feel.
6. **Viewing Needs**
   She wishes there were simple ways to help structure her reflections, such as light prompts or questions to quickly organize her thoughts about the characters or story impact.
7. **Daily Habits**
   Watching shows is integrated into her everyday life: coffee in hand, slowly following the story, quietly reflecting on the characters' emotions and the life lessons she can draw from them. This slow, reflective approach defines her main connection to the stories she enjoys.

## Eduardo Persona Scenario

**Name:** Eduardo 🇵🇪
**Age:** 26
**Background:** Peruvian student currently studying in Canada. Loves anime and series with meaningful stories.
**Lifestyle:** Balances studies with free time, enjoys engaging with stories that portray character growth and positive life themes.

**Eduardo's Viewing Journey**

1. **Daily Routine**
   Eduardo often relaxes after a day of classes by watching anime or TV series. He prefers stories that highlight character development and show the uplifting, hopeful side of life. Watching these shows is a way for him to unwind and feel inspired.

2. **Choosing Series and Complexity**
   He is selective about what he watches. If a series is too long or feels boring, he tends to drop it entirely. However, he enjoys complex stories as long as they are concise and engaging.
3. **Handling Forgotten Details**
   When he forgets details or characters, Eduardo usually just continues watching. Sometimes he looks up YouTube videos explaining the series, either during or after watching, to fill in gaps and understand the story fully.
4. **Emotional Engagement**
   Many characters have left a strong impression on Eduardo. For example, Shigeo Kageyama from *Mob Psycho* resonates with him because of the way the character struggles with emotions at first, and then learns to acknowledge and cherish them, even the uncomfortable ones.
5. **Reflection on Values**
   Eduardo enjoys observing how characters grow and how stories reflect life's challenges and positivity. These narratives inspire him and often make him reflect on his own approach to life and handling emotions.
6. **Viewing Habits and Needs**
   He prefers series that are emotionally engaging but not unnecessarily long. He likes concise explanations when needed, and stories that allow him to reflect quietly without having to share his thoughts publicly.
7. **Daily Engagement**
   Watching anime and TV series is both entertainment and personal reflection for Eduardo. He takes the time to notice character growth and life lessons, sometimes pausing to think about the emotional journey of the story or characters.

## Oke Persona Scenario

**Name:** Oke 🇳🇬
**Age:** 29
**Background:** Nigerian student currently studying in Canada. Loves coding and making meaningful connections.
**Lifestyle:** Balances studies with free time, enjoys thriller movies and series, and occasionally the classic murder mystery. He loves a good storyline.

Oke's Viewing Journey

1. **Daily Routine**
   After a day of coding and navigating the Canadian cold, Oke unwinds with high-stakes thrillers. He shifts his brain from the logic of syntax to the complex puzzles of human motives. These stories serve as a sharp mental palate cleanser after his intensive university studies.
2. **Choosing Series and Complexity**
   Oke is highly selective and has zero patience for filler episodes or predictable plotlines. He craves "tight" writing where every line of dialogue serves as a potential clue or function. If a series feels inefficient or "buggy" with plot holes, he drops it without a second thought
3. **Handling Forgotten Details**
   Approaching stories like a detective, he hates missing a key detail or a character's motive.

He often pauses to watch "Timeline Explained" videos to catch any hidden foreshadowing. This deep dive ensures he understands the full architecture of the mystery he is watching

4. **Emotional Engagement**
   He resonates with brilliant, burdened characters who use logic to navigate a chaotic world. Figures like L or Sherlock inspire him as he tackles his own journey as an international student. Seeing a character solve an impossible problem mirrors his satisfaction in mastering complex code.
5. **Reflection on Values**
   Oke reflects on the gray areas of morality and how characters maintain integrity under pressure. These narratives prompt him to think about his own resilience and the depth of his connections. He values stories that challenge his perspective on human nature and personal ethics.
6. **Viewing Habits and Needs**
   He prefers intellectually demanding, concise masterpieces over long, drawn-out seasonal epics. He values analytical recaps that break down the "why" behind a character's specific actions. This allows him to reflect privately on the story's craftsmanship before sharing it with friends.
7. **Daily Engagement**
   Watching is a mental exercise where he treats the plot like a puzzle to be solved. He frequently pauses to predict endings, analyzing the cinematography and pacing for clues. A solved mystery provides him the same satisfaction as a perfectly executed block of code.

### Anna Persona Scenario

**Name:** Anna Chou 🇨🇦
**Age:** 27
**Background:** First-generation Canadian student studying at UBC. Enjoys anime, romantic dramas, and character-driven stories.
**Lifestyle:** Balances university classes, studying, and time with friends. she often watch shows in the evening as a way to relax after school.

**Anna's Viewing Journey**

1. **Daily Routine**
   After finishing her classes and study sessions, Anna usually relaxes by watching an episode of anime or a TV series on her laptop. Watching shows is her way to unwind after a long day of schoolwork.
2. **Choosing Series and Complexity**
   Anna enjoys stories with strong characters and emotional development. She doesn't mind longer series, but sometimes finds it difficult to keep track of multiple characters and relationships.
3. **Handling Forgotten Details**
   If Anna forgets certain parts of the story, she sometimes searches online for explanations or quick summaries. However, she occasionally runs into spoilers, which can ruin future episodes.

4. **Emotional Engagement**
   She connects strongly with characters who go through personal struggles or growth. Seeing how characters deal with challenges often reminds her of situations in her own life.
5. **Reflection on Values**
   Anna sometimes reflects on the themes and messages behind the story, especially when characters face moral decisions or important life moments.

6. **Viewing Habits and Needs**
   She would like an easy way to review character relationships and story developments without accidentally seeing spoilers.
7. **Daily Engagement**
   Watching anime and TV series helps Anna relax and reflect after busy school days, and sometimes she discusses her favorite moments with friends.

### Delvin Persona Scenario

**Name:** Delvin Pascal 🇨🇦
**Age:** 30
**Background:** Works in Canada and enjoys watching action series, thrillers, and anime with complex storylines.
**Lifestyle:** Works full-time and watches shows in his free time to relax after work.

**Delvin's Viewing Journey**

1. **Daily Routine**
   After finishing work for the day, Delvin usually relaxes by watching a few episodes of a series. Watching shows helps him disconnect from work and enjoy some entertainment.
2. **Choosing Series and Complexity**
   He prefers shows with exciting plots, unexpected twists, and interesting characters. Complex storylines keep him engaged and curious about what will happen next.
3. **Handling Forgotten Details**
   When Delvin forgets certain details or characters, he sometimes searches online for quick explanations or episode summaries to understand the story better.
4. **Emotional Engagement**
   He enjoys characters who are clever, determined, or face difficult challenges. These characters make the story more exciting and memorable for him.
5. **Reflection on Values**
   While watching stories with moral dilemmas or tough decisions, Delvin sometimes reflects on how people react in difficult situations.
6. **Viewing Habits and Needs**
   He would appreciate a simple way to understand character connections and story progression without having to search through multiple websites.
7. **Daily Engagement**
   Watching shows is one of Delvin's main ways to relax. He enjoys discussing interesting plot twists and characters with friends after finishing an episode or series.